

Chapter 37 Part 2

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Liang Shi had originally planned to drive Xu Qingzhu to the company, but Xu Qingzhu said she had recovered and could drive herself.

So Liang Shi didn't insist.

Before work, Liang Shi bought her usual cup of coffee and encountered Li Ran and Zhou Li when going upstairs.

Li Ran was surprised again, "Little Liang, what's wrong with you? Is your wife still not feeling well?"

Liang Shi: "...She's recovered."

"Your dark circles are too big." Li Ran said: "Didn't you sleep last night?"

Liang Shi helplessly replied, "I slept, but didn't sleep well."

After seeing such terrifying things before bed, anyone would have trouble sleeping.

"Young as you are, how can you already have sleep problems?" Li Ran clicked her tongue, "Why don't you go to the hospital for a check-up?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Even Zhou Li on the side couldn't stand listening anymore and interjected: "Don't you ever stay up late?"

"Does staying up late for overtime count?" Li Ran said: "Usually I go to sleep at ten o'clock."

Zhou Li: "That's different from young people."

"Sister Li, you're also not..." Li Ran's half-sentence "young either" couldn't come out after meeting Zhou Li's death glare, and she could only swallow it silently.

Liang Shi stood to the side, extremely sleepy. She mainly had nightmares all night and had a headache.

"Little Liang." Li Ran changed the subject, "We're going to Yunfeng Mountain¹ to worship gods this week. Are you going?"

"Worship what gods?" Liang Shi asked.

"Just a Taoist temple." Li Ran said: "I heard it's quite effective, especially Master Yunyin². Many rich people go to him for fortune telling and changing their luck."

Liang Shi suddenly perked up, her eyes opening wider than before, "Changing luck?"

"That's right." Li Ran shrugged, "But it's just what I heard. I haven't seen anyone actually succeed. Of course, even if they did, we wouldn't know. There are also rumors that some people keep little ghosts³ at home. There are all sorts of mysterious rumors, but not many people believe them. Besides, after the founding of the nation, spirits aren't allowed to become immortals⁴. These things are just for peace of mind."

Zhou Li said coolly from the side, "I thought you were superstitious to that extent."

"How could that be?" Li Ran laughed awkwardly, "My mom is a firm materialist."

Zhou Li: "But you're not."

Li Ran: "..."

A few seconds later, Li Ran said: "Some things, you can't believe completely, but you can't disbelieve completely either."

She suddenly leaned closer to the two and said in a low voice: "Once before, my little cousin kept crying at night, crying terribly, especially at midnight. This was not long after my grandfather passed away. We took my cousin to the hospital for tests—we did all kinds of examinations but couldn't find anything wrong. Later we found a spirit medium who said she could communicate with spirits. She gave my cousin a bowl of something unknown to drink and performed some ritual at our house. You know what? My cousin stopped crying that very night."

Zhou Li: "...Maybe she was tired from crying."

Li Ran was stumped for a moment, but still said: "I'm not really sure either. According to that spirit medium, my grandfather's soul had returned. My cousin was young with a weak spiritual aura⁵, so she was affected. Adults generally aren't affected."

Zhou Li paused, "What did that spirit medium believe in?"

Li Ran: "...Seemed like Buddhism."

Zhou Li: "Then what are you going to a Taoist temple for?"

Li Ran: "..."

After a while, she muttered: "It doesn't hurt to believe in more things."

Zhou Li scoffed lightly, "When nothing's wrong, no one believes in anything. When something happens, whether it's Eastern gods and Buddhas or Western Jesus, they'll worship them all."

Li Ran: "...That's not without reason either."

Liang Shi listened silently to their conversation while searching for information about Yunfeng Mountain on her phone.

There were pictures of Yunfeng Mountain online, and it looked remarkably similar to the mountain she had seen in her dream last night. But it didn't have the lush mountains and clear waters surrounded by clouds and mist from her dream. It looked like it had been through modern industrialization and lost its original charm.

At the same time, she also searched for Master Yunyin that Li Ran mentioned. There were no pictures online, and very little information.

Most were online inquiries asking whether Master Yunyin of Yunfeng Mountain was effective, and when Master Yunyin would be at the temple.

After the two finished their discussion, Liang Shi asked Li Ran, "Sister Ran, when was that temple you mentioned established?"

"Seven or eight years ago, I think." Li Ran said: "No one had heard of it before, then suddenly there was this thing, and everyone said it was quite effective. What's wrong?"

"Have you ever seen Master Yunyin?" Liang Shi asked.

Li Ran shook her head: "He spends most of his time traveling the world⁶, not at the temple. It's all managed by his young disciple."

Zhou Li suddenly interjected, "When you say he travels the world, does he take planes or fly?"

Li Ran: "...Maybe he takes trains?"

Everyone fell silent together.

Just then the elevator stopped and everyone got out together.

Liang Shi asked: "Sister Ran, which day this week are you going?"

"Sunday morning." Li Ran said: "I'm going with a few people from the variety show department and camera crew."

"Count me in." Liang Shi said: "I'll go get a peace charm⁷."

"Sure thing." Li Ran turned to ask Zhou Li, "Sister Li, are you going?"

Zhou Li waved her hand, leaving them with a carefree silhouette, "I'm staying home to take care of the little one."

¹ **Yunfeng Mountain (雲峰山):** "Cloud Peak Mountain" - a fictional mountain in the story associated with mystical practices.

² **Master Yunyin (雲隱道長):** "Cloud Hidden Taoist Master" - a mysterious Taoist priest who practices fortune telling and feng shui.

³ **Little ghosts (小鬼):** In Chinese folk belief, refers to keeping spirits or supernatural entities for personal gain or protection, often considered a dark practice.

⁴ **After the founding of the nation, spirits aren't allowed to become immortals (建國以後不準成精):** A popular internet meme in China referring to how supernatural stories often end abruptly at 1949 (when the People's Republic of China was founded), suggesting that the new government doesn't allow supernatural beings to exist.

⁵ **Spiritual aura (魂幅):** Refers to one's spiritual strength or resistance to supernatural influences in Chinese folk belief.

⁶ **Traveling the world (雲游四海):** A traditional term for Taoist monks who wander from place to place practicing and teaching.

⁷ **Peace charm (平安符):** Traditional protective talismans sold at temples, believed to bring safety and ward off evil.